Balance — User Guide for Judges

Balance helps a university student whose plan no longer fits the day. It shows how far the day is over capacity, compares safe ways to fix it, changes nothing until the student confirms, protects real free time for rest, and lets the student reflect privately.

Time needed: about 15 minutes for the full walkthrough. **Help needed:** none. **App version:** this guide matches Balance **v1.0.8** (26 October 2026), the latest release.

This guide has three parts:

- **Part A — Walkthrough (steps 1–8):** do these in order to see the whole journey.
- **Part B — Page reference:** every button and label on every page, for checking details.
- **Part C — Glossary, privacy, troubleshooting and limitations.**

> **About the screenshots.** They were taken on a team test account that holds the same sample data as the judge account, so the dates in them differ. On the judge account the sample day is **Sunday 1 November 2026**; everything else looks the same.

Part A — Walkthrough

Quick path

Step	Page	What you will do	Time
1	—	Install, sign in, go through the five-step beginner guide	2 min
2	TODAY	See a 2-hour overload, the day's free time and tasks, and five workload bars	3 min
3	QUESTS	Open the two tasks behind the overload	1 min
4	COUNCIL	Read the suggested fix and confirm it	2 min
5	COUNCIL	Check the result, then undo the plan from Plan history	2 min
6	SANCTUARY	Protect 30 minutes of rest from a suggested free time, then remove it	2 min
7	JOURNEY	See the weekly summary, the achievement wall and a new badge	2 min
8	PROFILE	Optional: sound, reminders and overload alerts	1 min

Before you start

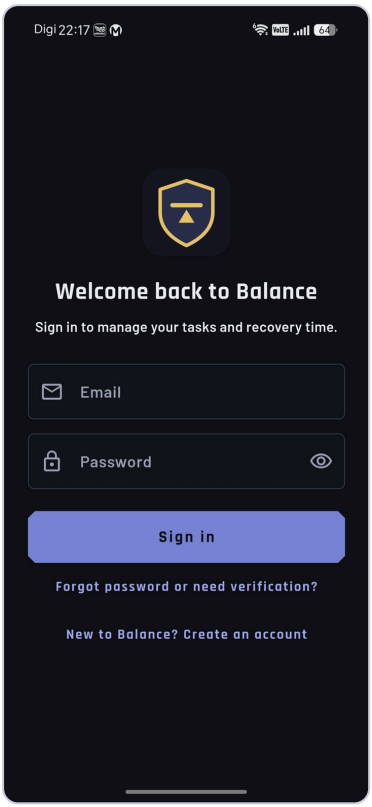
You need	Details
An Android phone	Android 8.0 or later, with internet.
Malaysia time on the phone	Settings → System → Date & time → use automatic time zone. Balance shows times in the phone's time zone.
The Balance app	Latest release → download `app-release.apk`.
The judge account	Email and password are in our submission form. They are never stored in this repository.
The sample day	**Sunday 1 November 2026.** On that date Balance opens directly on it.

Shared account. All judges use the same account. Please undo any plan you confirm and remove any recovery time you add (steps 5 and 6), so the next judge sees the same day.

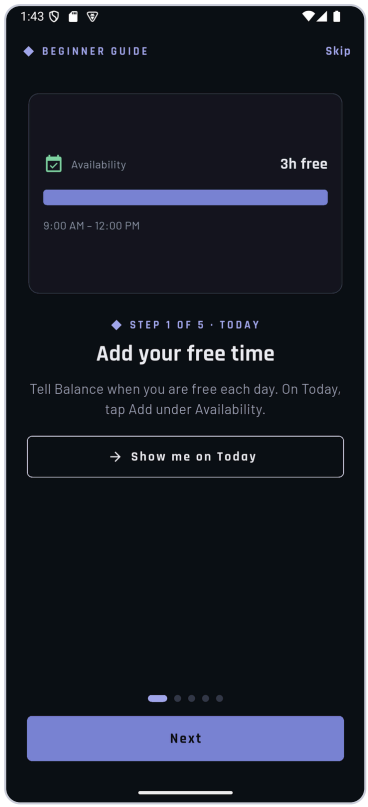
Step 1 — Install, sign in and follow the beginner guide

1. On the phone, open the release link and download `app-release.apk`.
2. Open the downloaded file. If Android asks, allow installing apps from this source, then tap **Install**. If an older Balance build is installed, uninstall it first.
3. Open **Balance**. Enter the judge **Email** and **Password** and tap **Sign in**. *Forgot password or need verification?* and *Create an account* are not needed.
4. The first time, the **Beginner guide** appears: five short steps, each with one sentence and a small animation: **Add your free time**, **Add your tasks**, **See if your day fits**, **Fix it safely** and **Rest and look back**.
   - **Next** and **Back** move between steps; **Get started** on the last step closes it.
   - Tap an animation to play it again. With *Remove animations* turned on in Android's accessibility settings, each step shows its finished picture instead.

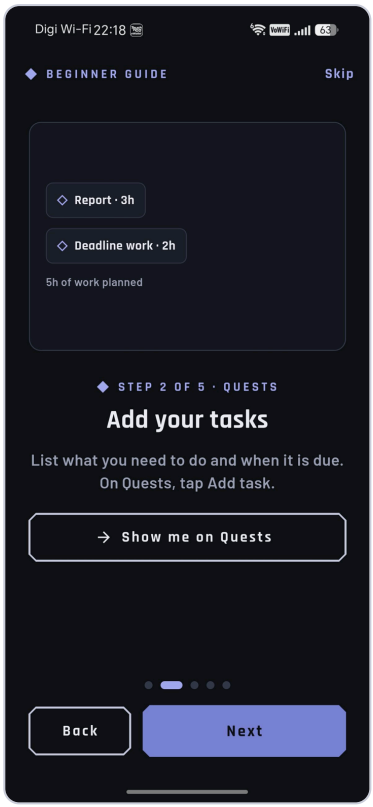
- **Show me on …** closes the guide and opens that page.
- **Skip** closes it at any time. You can reopen it later from **Profile** → **Beginner guide**.



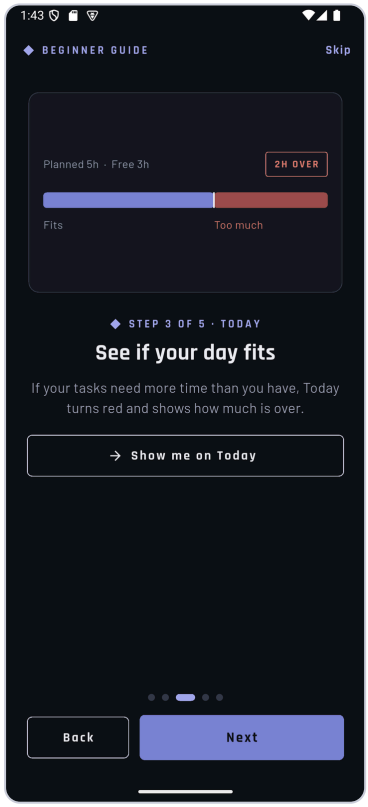
Sign-in screen



Beginner guide, step 1 of 5



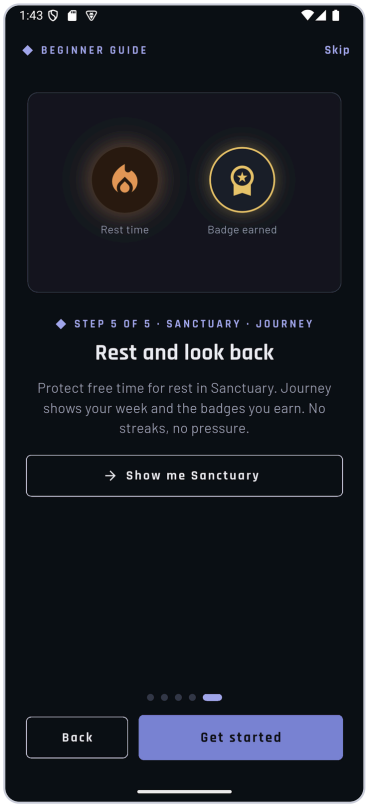
Beginner guide, step 2 of 5



Beginner guide, step 3 of 5



Beginner guide, step 4 of 5



Beginner guide, step 5 of 5

You now see the **TODAY** page. If a yellow "Local preview" banner appears, this is not the release build; reinstall from the release link.

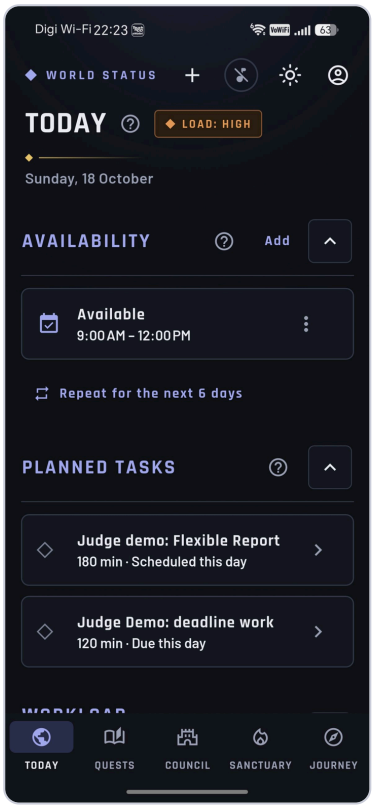
Step 2 — See the overload (TODAY)

What you see first. The top of Today answers one question: *does the day fit?*

1. If the date under **TODAY** is not the sample day, tap the → (Next day) arrow until it is. The middle label says *Viewing today*, *Viewing tomorrow* or the date.
2. **Time capacity** shows **3h available** and **5h planned**. The bar shows the part that fits (blue) and the part beyond capacity (red). The red tag says **2H OVER**.
3. Below it, the red **Capacity gap** card states the consequence: *120 minutes must be moved, reduced or recovered.* When a day fits, this card is green and says **Plan is balanced** instead.
4. The badge at the top right, **LOAD: BUILDING** (or Low, High, Over capacity), summarises the five workload bars further down. It is about workload, not about whether time fits.



Today: capacity and verdict



Today: availability and planned tasks

The day's time and work. Scroll down a little.

5. **Availability** lists the free time on this day: *Judge demo: day 1, 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM*.
   - **Add** (or **+** at the top) adds another time block.
   - The ⋮ menu on a block offers **Edit** and **Delete**.
   - **Repeat for the next 6 days** copies this day's time to the coming days. An empty day shows **Copy from** *(previous day)* instead. **On the shared judge account, please only look at these two buttons**, so the sample week stays the same.
6. **Planned tasks** lists what counts on this day: *Judge demo: flexible report* (180 min, scheduled this day) and *Judge demo: deadline work* (120 min, due this day). Tap a task to see why it counts on this day.

The five workload bars. Scroll further.

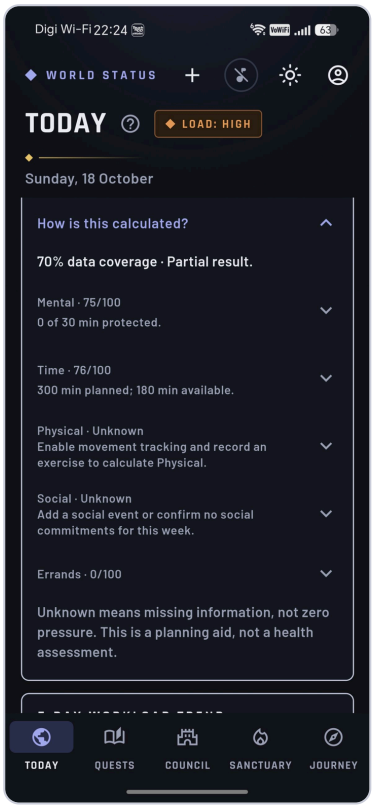
7. **Workload Overview · World Status** shows the **Load** total (for example *49/100 · Building*) and five bars in a fixed order: **Mental, Time, Physical, Social, Errands**.

- Each bar is a score from 0 to 100; higher means more planning pressure.
- A bar with no data says **Unknown**. Balance never treats missing data as zero.
- An asterisk (*) after a score means it is partial: some of its inputs are unknown.
- **▲ / ▼** next to a bar shows its change since yesterday (▲ more pressure, ▼ less), only when the previous day also has a record. A dash means no change.
- **Calamity · workload trend** says *Rising*, *Stable*, *Easing* or *Not enough history*.

8. Tap **How is this calculated?** to open one line per bar: the score and its main reason (for example *Time · 76/100 — 300 min planned; 180 min available*). Tap a bar's line for the full breakdown. The last line reminds you that this is a planning aid, not a health assessment.



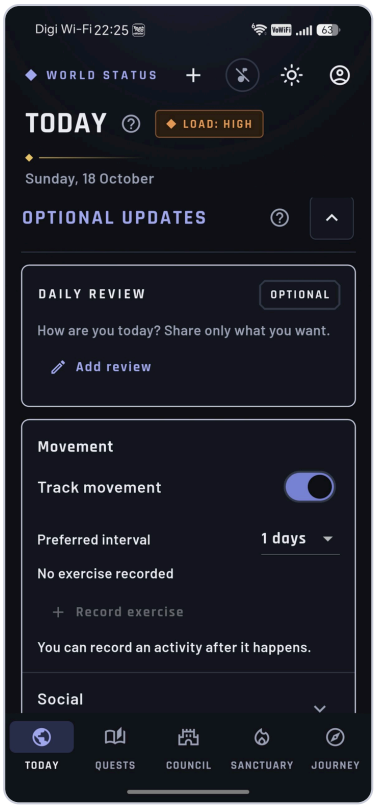
Today: five workload bars



Today: how the scores are calculated

Optional updates. At the bottom of Today.

9. **7-day workload trend** shows each day's total once at least three days are recorded; before that it says how many days are recorded so far. Missing days are never invented.
10. **Optional updates** add detail to the workload bars. Skipping them has no penalty. This section starts folded: tap its chevron (˅) to open it.
    - **Daily Review** — *Add review* asks for mental energy, physical energy and hours of rest; **Skip for now** is always available.
    - **Movement** — *Track movement* turns on the Physical bar, with a preferred interval and *Record exercise*.
    - **Social** — expand it to add a social event or mark *No commitments this week*.



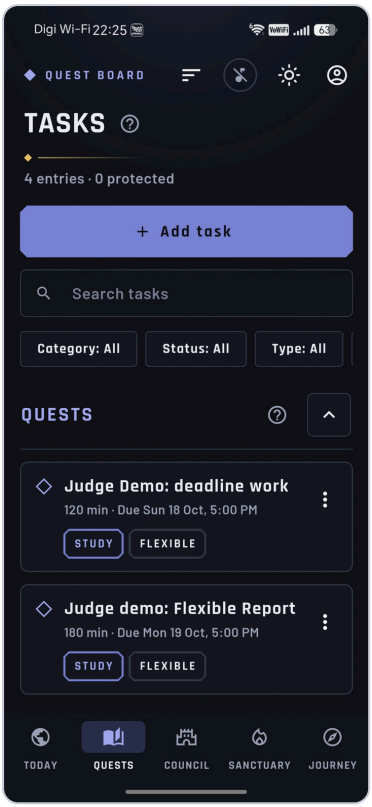
Today: trend and optional updates

Step 3 — Look at the tasks (QUESTS)

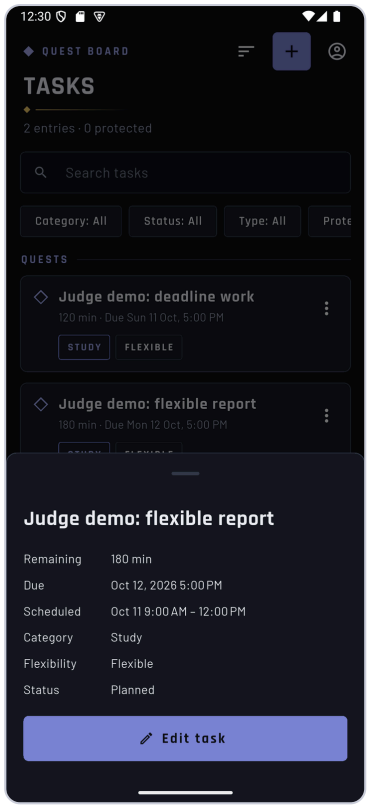
1. Tap **QUESTS** in the bottom bar. The page title is **TASKS** (*Quest Board*), with a count such as *2 entries · 0 protected*.
2. The sample tasks are below. Together they need 5 hours, but the sample day has only 3 hours free.

Task	Length	Scheduled	Deadline
Judge demo: flexible report	3h	9:00 AM – 12:00 PM on the sample day	The next day, 5:00 PM
Judge demo: deadline work	2h	Not scheduled	The sample day, 5:00 PM

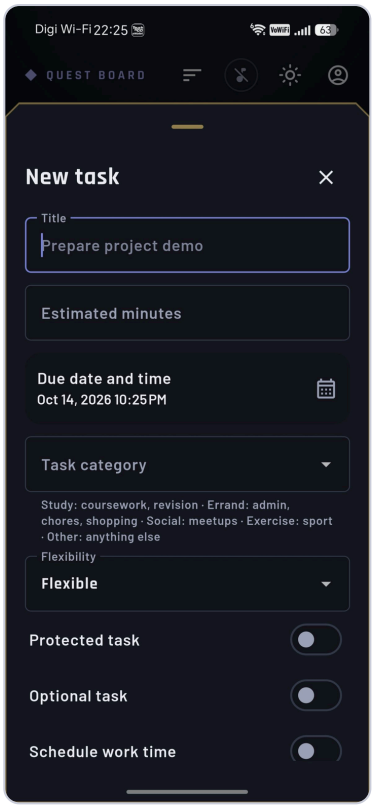
3. **Tap a task card** to open its details: remaining time, due date, scheduled time, category, flexibility and status, with an **Edit task** button.
4. Optional: tap the full-width **Add task** button above the search box to see the new task form, then close it without saving. A task needs a **Title**, **Estimated minutes**, **Due date and time** and a **Task category**; the form explains each category. **Flexibility** (Flexible, Fixed, Needs agreement), **Protected task**, **Optional task** and **Schedule work time** are set here too.



Quest Board



Task details



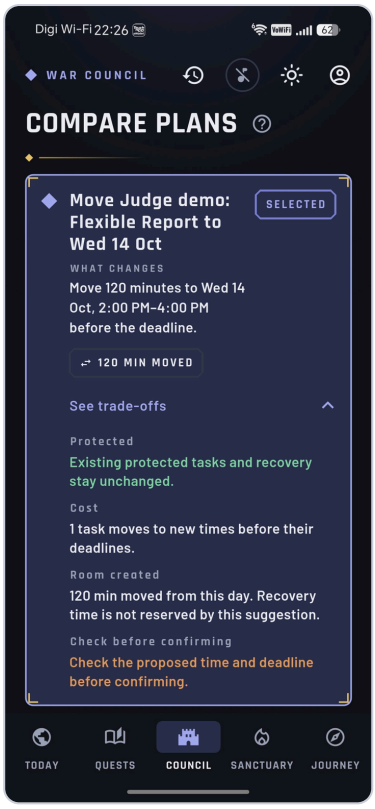
New task form

Step 4 — Read the suggested fix and confirm it (COUNCIL)

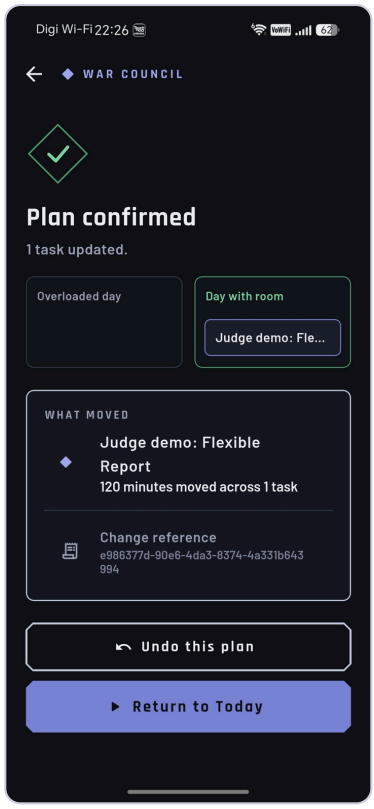
1. Tap **COUNCIL**. The page is **COMPARE PLANS** (*War Council*). Use the arrows so the date reads the sample day.
2. The top repeats the problem: **Over capacity**, **300 MIN planned → 180 MIN available**, *Capacity gap: 120 minutes*. **What stays protected** lists anything Council will never move (none on the sample day). The tag **FEASIBLE** means at least one safe option exists.
3. Under **Choose a plan** — *Suggestions only. Nothing moves until confirmed.* — the option reads **Move Judge demo: flexible report to** *(the next day)*: *Move 120 minutes, 9:00 AM – 11:00 AM, before the deadline.* Tap **See trade-offs** on the card to read the cost on the next day, what stays protected, the room created and anything to check.
4. Tap the option to select it (it shows **SELECTED**), then tap **Confirm selected plan**. The plan is saved at once; the server checks every rule again before saving. A soft chime plays if sound effects are on.
5. **Plan confirmed** draws a tick, and a card slides from *Overloaded day* to *Day with room* to show the move. Below, it lists what moved and offers **Undo this plan** and **Return to Today**.



Council: the problem

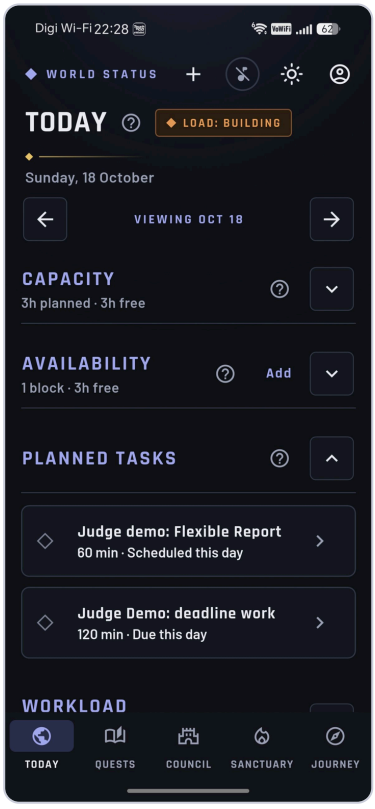


Council: the suggested option



Plan confirmed

6. Tap **Return to Today** and move to the next day: the report now shows **120 min · Moved here by a plan**, and the day still fits. Back on the sample day, the report shows the **60 min** that stayed there, and the day is no longer over capacity.



The sample day after confirming: 60 min of the report stays, the day fits

Step 5 — Undo the plan (COUNCIL → Plan history)

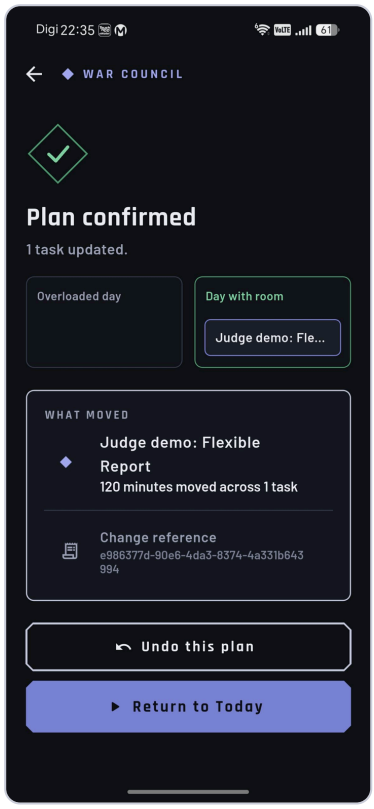
Any confirmed plan can be undone, even after leaving the result screen.

1. Open **COUNCIL** and tap the **Plan history** icon (clock) at the top right.
2. Tap the plan marked **Confirmed**. Its screen shows what moved; tap **Undo this plan**.
3. **Changes were undone** confirms the task was restored (the card slides back). On **TODAY**, the sample day is **2H OVER** again and the next day is free.

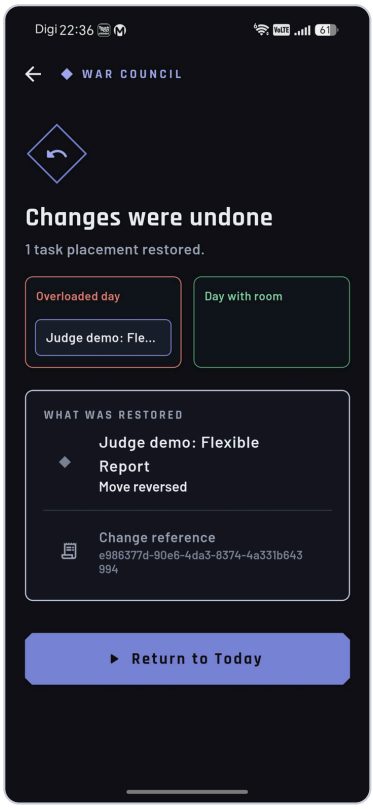
If the task was edited after the plan was confirmed, Undo is refused with an explanation instead of overwriting the newer change.



Plan history



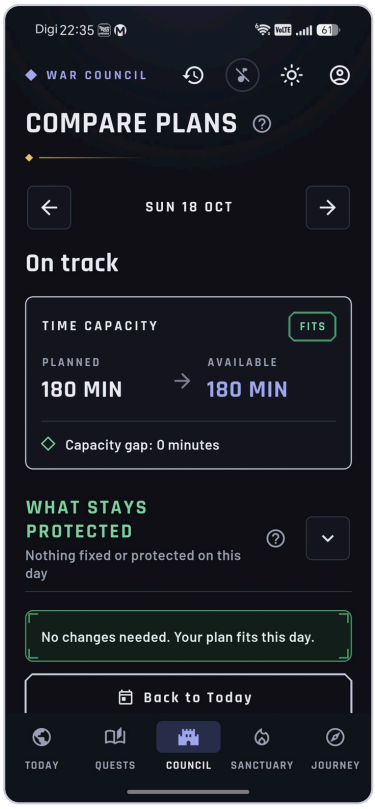
A confirmed plan with Undo



Changes were undone

Please always undo your plan, so the sample day stays ready for the next judge.

On a day that already fits, Council shows one line instead of options: *No changes needed. Your plan fits this day.* On a day with no tasks and no free time added, it says *Nothing planned yet* instead.



Council on a day that fits

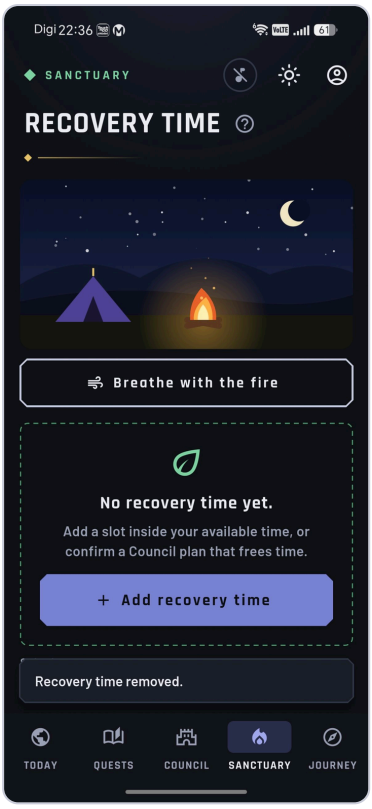
Step 6 — Protect rest time (SANCTUARY)

Recovery time is optional, and Balance only lets you protect time that is genuinely free.

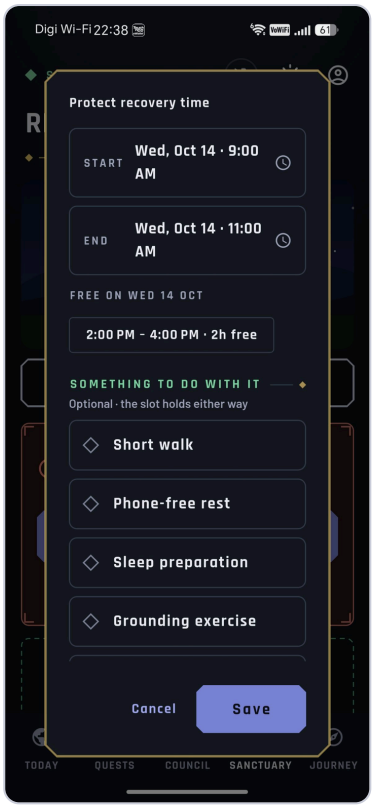
At the top is the **rest camp**: a tent beside a small campfire. The sky follows your phone's clock (dawn, day, dusk or night), the fire flickers gently, and while background music is on you hear a soft crackle that stops when you leave the page.

- Optional: tap **Breathe with the fire** for one minute of slow breathing. Breathe in for 4 seconds, hold for 4 and breathe out for 4 while the fire grows and settles with you. **Stop** works at any time, and nothing is recorded or scored.

1. Tap **SANCTUARY**. The page is **RECOVERY TIME**. With no slots yet it says *No recovery time yet* and offers **Add recovery time**. Once you have slots, the same full-width button sits above the list.
2. Tap **Add recovery time**. The form **Protect recovery time** finds free time for you: the sample day is fully booked, so it shows **Free on** *(the next day)* with the suggestion **9:00 AM – 11:00 AM · 2h free**, already selected as **Start 9:00 AM** and **End 9:30 AM**. Tap another suggestion, or tap Start or End to pick a time yourself.
3. **Something to do with it** lists optional ideas (Short walk, Phone-free rest, Sleep preparation, Grounding exercise, Reflection prompt, Visit a campus support service, Something else). The slot is protected whether or not you choose one.
4. Tap **Save**. The slot appears under **All recovery slots** as **Free rest time** (or the activity you chose) with the tag **TIME RESERVED** and *30m held clear*. Your next protected slot is also shown at the top under **Next rest**, with its day and time. Once a slot has started, **Mark activity done** records it (before then the button reads *Mark done after it starts*); **Undo activity done** reverses it.
5. **Please remove it afterwards**: open its ⋮ menu → **Remove** → **Remove**. A slot on the next day would use the free time that the Council plan in step 4 needs.



Sanctuary with no slots

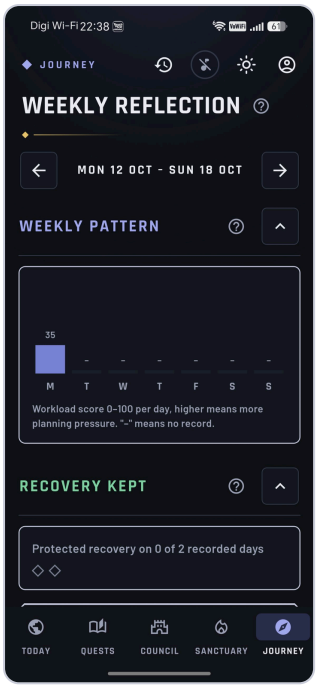


Protect recovery time with suggestions

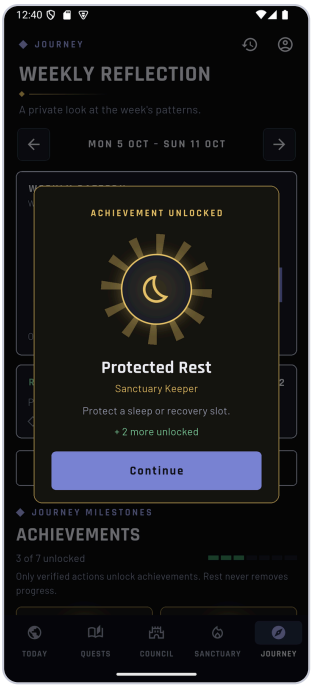
If there is no free time in the 7 days from the chosen start, the form says *No free time in the 7 days from …* and asks you to add availability on Today first. If you choose a time outside the available time, Balance explains why and offers **Go to Today** or **Choose another time**. Marking an activity done never changes a workload score; rest is not graded, and skipping it has no penalty.

Step 7 — Weekly summary and achievement wall (JOURNEY)

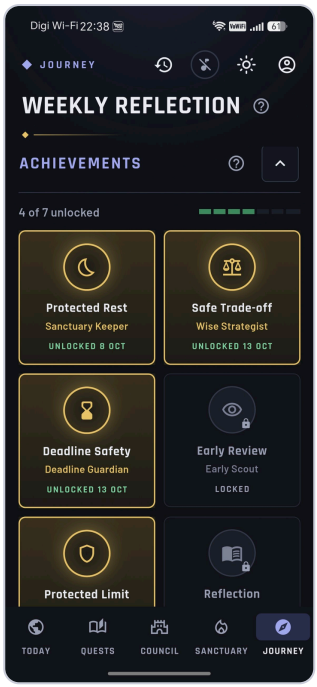
1. Tap **JOURNEY**. The page is **WEEKLY REFLECTION**. Use the week arrows to reach the week of the sample day.
2. **Weekly pattern** shows the recorded World Status score for each day; days without a record show no bar, and past scores are never invented. **Recovery kept** counts days with protected recovery.
3. Optional: **Add optional reflection** opens a short private note (*What worked for you this week?*). The **My reflections** icon (clock) at the top lists earlier reflections.
4. **Achievements** is a wall of seven badges. Earned badges glow gold with their date; locked badges are dimmed with a lock. **Tap a badge** to see how it is earned.
5. Confirming the plan in step 4 can earn **Safe Trade-off** (*Wise Strategist*) and **Deadline Safety** (*Deadline Guardian*). A newly earned badge is celebrated once with an **ACHIEVEMENT UNLOCKED** animation and a chime when you next open Journey. Badges are earned once per account, so some may already be unlocked if another judge used the account first.
6. **Team Coordination** stays **Locked**: it needs shared tasks, planned for a later version.



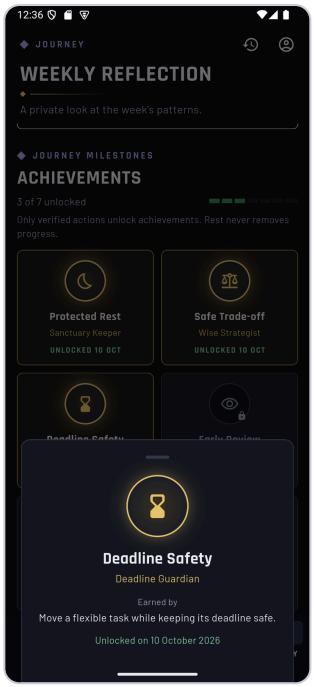
Journey weekly summary



Achievement unlocked



Achievement wall

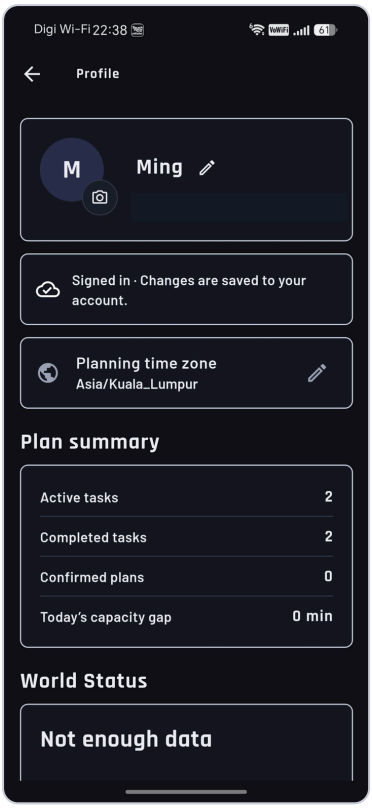


Badge details

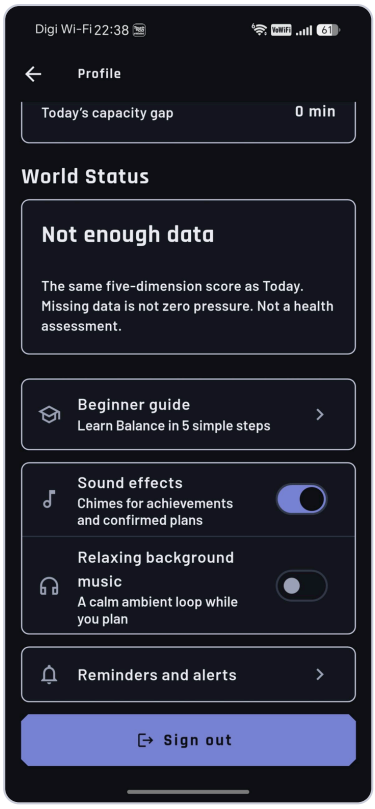
There are no streaks, rankings or penalties for skipping.

Step 8 — Profile, sound, reminders and alerts (optional)

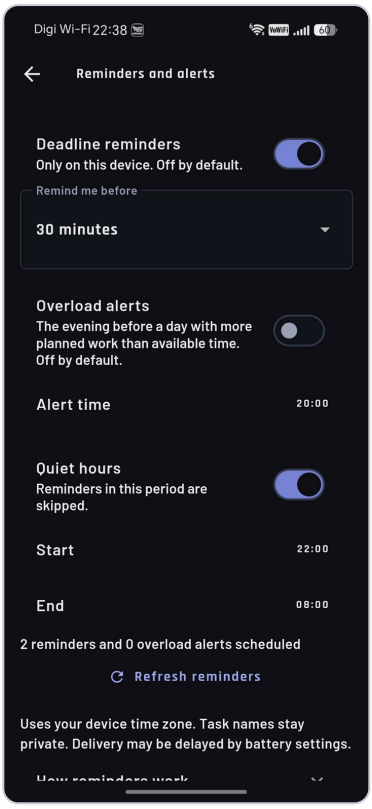
1. Tap the round **profile icon** at the top right of any main page.
2. **Profile** shows the signed-in account, *Signed in · Changes are saved to your account*, the **Planning time zone** (*Asia/Kuala_Lumpur*), a **Plan summary** and the same **World Status** score as Today. **Edit name** changes the display name, and the camera badge on the round picture lets you choose a profile photo (kept on this phone only). On the shared judge account, please leave the name and photo as they are.
3. **Beginner guide** reopens the five-step guide with animations.
4. **Sound effects** (on by default) plays chimes for confirmed plans and new achievements. **Relaxing background music** (on by default) plays a calm ambient loop and pauses when the app is in the background. To silence it at once, tap the gold **music note** button at the top of any main page; it turns grey with a crossed-out note when the music is off. All audio is original to Balance.
5. **Reminders and alerts**:
   - **Deadline reminders** — a reminder a set time before each task deadline: 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 1 hour, 1 day, or **Custom minutes…** (1 to 10080 minutes).
   - **Overload alerts** — a notification the evening before a day with more planned work than available time; **Alert time** defaults to 8:00 PM.
   - **Quiet hours** — reminders and alerts are skipped between **Start** and **End**.
   - Both are off by default and ask for notification permission when turned on.
6. **Sign out** ends the session on this phone.



Profile



Profile settings



Reminders and alerts

Part B — Page reference

Bottom bar and header

Element	What it does
TODAY (globe), **QUESTS** (quest book), **COUNCIL** (castle), **SANCTUARY** (campfire), **JOURNEY** (compass)	The five main pages. The phone's Back gesture returns to Today, then leaves the app.
Eyebrow label (e.g. *WORLD STATUS*) and title (e.g. *TODAY*)	The game-style label and the practical page name.
Gold music note	Turns the background music off or on (gold = playing, grey = off).
Sun / moon	Switches between the dark look and the light parchment look; the choice is remembered.
Round profile icon	Opens Profile.
Clock icon	*Plan history* on Council; *My reflections* on Journey.
? next to a title	Shows a one-line description of the page or section; tap again to hide it.
Chevron (˅ / ^) on a section	Folds or unfolds that section. The main sections start open; *Optional updates* and *Finished* start folded. Your choice is remembered on this phone.
+	Today: add a time block. (Quests and Sanctuary use the full-width **Add task** and **Add recovery time** buttons.)

TODAY (World Status)

Element	Meaning
LOAD: Low / Building / High / Over capacity / No data	Summary of the five workload bars (0–24 Low, 25–49 Building, 50–74 High, 75–100 Over capacity).
← *Viewing …* →	Change the day shown.
Time capacity	Planned vs available time; tag **FITS**, **NO TIME ADDED** or **…H OVER**. The tag shows the full capacity gap, the same number as Council; it can be larger than the red bar when work is due before the free time starts (the Capacity gap card explains the split).
Capacity gap / **Plan is balanced**	The verdict for the day.
I reviewed this overload	Appears for an overload with a later deadline; recording it early can earn *Early Review*.
Availability	Free time blocks; **Add**, ⋮ **Edit/Delete**, **Copy from**, **Repeat for the next 6 days**.
Planned tasks	Work that counts on this day, with its minutes on this day and why: *Scheduled this day*, *Due this day* or *Moved here by a plan*. Tap for details.

Element	Meaning
Workload Overview	Load total and the five bars, ▲/▼ changes, Calamity trend, *How is this calculated?*
7-day workload trend	Daily totals for the last seven days once three are recorded.
Optional updates	Daily Review, Movement, Social.

QUESTS (Quest Board)

Element	Meaning
Sort icon	Sort tasks (for example *Due soonest*).
Search	Filter by title.
Category / Status / Type / Protection chips	Filters; *Clear filters* resets them.
Sections	*Sacred contracts* (protected), *Quests*, *Finished*.
Tags	**OVERDUE**, the category (STUDY, ERRAND, SOCIAL, EXERCISE, OTHER), flexibility (FLEXIBLE, FIXED, NEEDS AGREEMENT), **PROTECTED**. An old task without a category shows *Uncategorized · Needs Review*.
⋮ menu	**Mark as done** / **Mark as not done**, **Edit**, **Delete**. Marking an Exercise task done asks whether to record the exercise; *Skip* records nothing. A task that was part of a confirmed plan (even one later undone) stays in plan history, so it cannot be deleted: use **Mark as done** instead.
Tap a card	Task details with **Edit task**.

COUNCIL (War Council)

Element	Meaning
Status tag	**FEASIBLE** (a safe option exists), **NEEDS REVIEW** (information missing), **NEEDS AGREEMENT** (someone else must agree), **NO FEASIBLE PLAN** (no safe move).
How Council decides	It moves only flexible work (scheduled on the day, or due on it without a start time), whole or in part, into free time on another day before the deadline. Fixed and protected tasks and protected rest never move; one plan moves at most three tasks.
What stays protected	Fixed and protected tasks and protected recovery that will not move.
Option card	What moves, where and when; **See trade-offs** shows cost, protection, room created and checks.
Confirm selected plan	Saves the selected option after the server re-checks it.
No safe move found	Explains why (for example work due on this day with no other day to move to, or recovery time using the only free time). When extra free time would help, it says how much and on which day (*Add 2h of free time on Wed 14 Oct* …) with an **Add free time on …** button. Tasks that block the plan have **Edit task** (change the deadline or minutes); **Review tasks** opens Quests.

Element	Meaning
Plan history	Every confirmed plan; open one to **Undo this plan**.

SANCTUARY (Recovery time)

Element	Meaning
Rest camp	Tent and campfire; the sky follows the clock. Still picture when animations are turned off.
Breathe with the fire	One minute of guided breathing (4 s in, 4 s hold, 4 s out); optional and never recorded.
Add recovery time	Opens *Protect recovery time* with free-time suggestions.
Next rest	Your next protected slot: day, time (for example *11:00 AM – 11:30 AM*), **PROTECTED** and *held clear. Nothing will be scheduled into it.*
All recovery slots	Each slot card: **Free rest time** or the chosen activity, the day and time, **TIME RESERVED**; ⋮ **Edit/Remove**; **Mark activity done** once it has started (**ACTIVITY DONE**, with **Undo activity done**).
Footer	Skipping has no penalty; rest does not change scores; not a medical service.

JOURNEY (Weekly reflection)

Element	Meaning
Week arrows	Change the week shown.
Weekly pattern	Recorded daily scores; no bar means no record.
Recovery kept	Days with protected recovery out of recorded days.
Add optional reflection / **My reflections**	Write and read private notes.
Achievements	Seven badges; tap one for its condition and date.

The seven achievements

Badge	RPG name	Earned by
Protected Rest	Sanctuary Keeper	Protecting a sleep or recovery slot.
Safe Trade-off	Wise Strategist	Confirming a plan without breaking protected commitments.
Deadline Safety	Deadline Guardian	Moving a flexible task while keeping its deadline safe.
Early Review	Early Scout	Reviewing an overload before the deadline day.
Protected Limit	Contract Keeper	Protecting a work shift, family duty or sleep minimum.
Reflection	Camp Journal Entry	Saving an optional reflection.
Team Coordination	Team Navigator	Marking a shared task as Needs Agreement (later version).

Part C — Glossary, privacy, troubleshooting and limitations

Glossary

Practical name	RPG label	Meaning
Workload Overview	World Status	Today's capacity, verdict and five workload bars.
Tasks and protected commitments	Quest Board, Sacred contracts	Your tasks; protected ones never move.
Plan comparison	War Council	Safe ways to fix an overloaded day.
Recovery time	Sanctuary	Protected free time for optional rest.
Weekly reflection	Journey	Private weekly summary and achievements.
Overload alert	Calamity Alert	Optional evening notification before an overloaded day.
Unknown	—	No data yet. Never treated as zero.
Partial (*)	—	Some inputs of a score are unknown.

Privacy and safety

- Each account sees only its own data; the database enforces this.
- Reflections and the weekly summary are private. There are no rankings or comparisons.
- Notifications use generic wording without task titles.
- Crash reports contain errors only: no screenshots, IP address or email.
- Balance is a planning aid. Its scores describe recorded planning data; it is not a medical, diagnostic or mental-health tool.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"Could not connect" with **Try again**	Check the internet connection, then tap **Try again**. Data already on screen stays visible.
The sample day is not 2h over	Check that you are on the sample day. If a plan is still confirmed, undo it in **COUNCIL** → **Plan history**.
Times look several hours off (for example availability at 1:00 AM)	Set the phone to Malaysia time (Settings → System → Date & time → automatic time zone), then reopen Balance.
Council shows **No Feasible Plan** on your own day	Read *Why*. Most often there is not enough free time on another day before the deadline: tap **Add free time on …** for the day Council names. If the work is due on that same day, ask for a later deadline or tap **Edit task** if it can take less time. Fixed and protected work never moves, by design.

What you see	What to do
Council shows **No Feasible Plan** on the sample day	A recovery slot is using the next day's free time; the explanation names it. Remove it in **SANCTUARY** (step 6.5).
This task is part of your plan history, so it cannot be deleted	Plan history keeps every task that was part of a confirmed plan. Use ⋮ → **Mark as done**; the task stops counting on every day.
No free time in the 7 days from … when protecting rest	Add availability on **TODAY** for one of those days first, then add recovery time again.
The beginner guide does not appear	It shows once per phone. Open **Profile** → **Beginner guide**.
No sound	Check that the music note at the top of the page is gold, **Profile** → **Sound effects**, and the phone's media volume.
Music is playing and you want quiet	Tap the gold music note at the top of any main page.
Sign-in fails	Check the email and password from the submission form for typing errors.
For security, wait … seconds and the button reads **Try again in …s**	Too many requests in a short time. Wait for the countdown; the button unlocks by itself.
"Can't install app"	Uninstall any earlier Balance build first, then install again.

What Balance does not claim

- Android is the supported platform. iOS has not been tested on a device, and the web build is not part of this submission.
- Every task needs a deadline; a "No deadline" option is not available yet.
- Shared tasks and the Team Coordination badge are planned for a later version.
- The app is currently English-only. Bahasa Melayu and Chinese are planned.